ONE AT A TIME · CHURCHY WORDS · BEYOND
BORING · THOSE PEOPLE



FALL 2026

Group Leader Content · Southeast Students

2026–2027

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SECTION 00

START UP

EVERYTHING TO KNOW BEFORE YOU LEAD A GROUP

IN THIS SECTION

START UP

Before the first group meets, walk through these four essentials. They set the rhythm, keep students safe, and define the kind of leader we're committing to be.

01 USING THIS GUIDE — 1
HOW TO LEAD A WEEK

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WHO & WHAT WE COMMIT TO

FOR SMALL-GROUP LEADERS

USING THIS GUIDE

Every week follows the same rhythm. The left page is your **prep**—know it before group. The right page is your **discussion**—use it to guide discussion.

PASSAGE	The week's Scripture. Read it together before you dig in.
KEY TAKEAWAY	The one idea students should leave with. Aim everything here.
CALL TO ACTION	The response you're guiding them toward this week.
QUESTIONS	**Personal** warms them up. **Biblical** digs into the text. **Applicable** brings it home.
PRAYER PROMPT	Pray it as written, or put it in your own words.
PERSONAL CHALLENGE	A step for students to carry through the week.

01 | Facilitate, don't teach. Use more question marks than periods, leave room for silence, and follow up with your students through the week. #leadertip

GUARDARILS

STOPLIGHT GUIDE

SCAN FOR THE FULL COURSE



SE Students wants every leader to promote safety and awareness in tough conversations. Ministry is messy and these topics can feel intimidating—here are the **guidelines for how to best proceed**.

GREEN LIGHT

"Green means go."

You've got this. You have both the Sword and the Spirit.

- Family problems
- Relational problems
- Homesickness
- Heartfelt confessions
- Questions about dating & sex
- Church & theological questions

YELLOW LIGHT

"Proceed with caution."

Mention it to a staff member for coaching.

- Bullying
- Pornography
- Eating disorders
- Drugs or alcohol
- Anxiety or depression
- Engagement in sexual activity
- Gender & sexual identity questions

RED LIGHT

"Stop and get help."

Get a staff member and bring them into the conversation.

- Self-injury
- Hearing voices / hallucinations
- Sexual & physical abuse reported
- Suicidal / homicidal thoughts (threats to harm)

STUDENT TO LEADER: IN PERSON

Southeast takes seriously the responsibility of keeping our people safe. Here are some best practices when interacting with students in person.

PROGRAMMING

- **Keep students in programming.** We want all students in the student room. If a student wants to talk one-on-one, wait until after program and groups end, and meet in a public area where you are visible to others.
- **Appropriate interactions.** Appropriate touches with a student: handshakes, high-fives, and side hugs.
- **When a student's ride is late.** Never leave a student waiting alone—wait with two adults. If you have a parent or guardian's permission to drive a student home, bring another cleared adult.

COUNSELING

- **Counsel same gender.** If a student of the opposite gender comes to you for counsel, connect them with a leader of the same gender.
- **Be visible.** Meet in a public area where you are visible to other people. Never meet in private.
- **Review the Counseling Spotlight.** When counseling a student, refer to the **Stoplight Guide** on how to best proceed in conversation.

OUTSIDE OF CHURCH

- **Pair up with another leader.** When planning an outside activity with students, always include another cleared adult and stay within the 1:25 student/leader ratio.
- **Transporting students.** Never give a student a ride home unless you have another cleared leader in the vehicle and a parent's or guardian's approval.
- **Communicating digitally.** When texting or using social media with students, follow the **Digital Communication Safety Guardrails** on the next page.

STUDENT TO LEADER: ONLINE

When it comes to digital interactions, the following are some best practices to promote safety and create a healthy environment between leaders and students.

TALK TO PARENTS FIRST

Make parents and guardians fully aware of all the digital methods that will be used to communicate with students for ministry purposes.

KEEP IT PLURAL

Want to let an absent student know they were missed, or tell someone you're proud of them? Use plural pronouns instead of singular ones. Rather than "I missed you," say "We missed you."

ADD A CO-LEADER

Adding another leader helps with accountability. Group texting is the preference for all digital communication. At no time should one-on-one video communication take place between a student and leader.

COMMUNICATION LIMITS

Most conversations can wait until the next day—a healthy boundary. Use "scheduled sending" for messages composed outside acceptable hours (e.g. write a message at 9:30 p.m. and schedule it to go out at 7:00 a.m. the next day).

TRACEABLE COMMUNICATION

Apps with a "self-destruct mode" can create dangers when adults use them to communicate with minors. To be above reproach, only communicate with students in ways that are traceable. Never delete a conversation with a student.

HIGH CALLING

LEADER COMMITMENT

Serving with minors is a trusted leadership role. The following commitments define **who we commit to be** and **what we commit to do** so students are discipled, cared for, and protected with integrity.

WHAT WE COMMIT TO BE

01	**Christ Follower**	I acknowledge Jesus Christ as Lord and will keep growing through the Bible, prayer, worship, and community in the life of the church.
02	**Representative**	I represent Jesus, Southeast Christian Church, Southeast Students and will support the church's mission, beliefs, leadership, and unity.
03	**Above Reproach**	I will live with integrity in my words, actions, relationships, habits, and online presence, and will not knowingly misrepresent Jesus or Southeast.
04	**Trustworthy**	I will use my influence to protect, encourage, and disciple students—never to manipulate, isolate, shame, favor, or create inappropriate dependence.
05	**Teachable**	I will receive coaching, correction, and direction with humility. Teachability is part of faithful leadership.
06	**Disciple-Maker**	This is more than a weekly program. I will pray for students, help them feel known, and point them to Jesus and their next steps of faith.
07	**Integrity**	If my ability to lead with integrity becomes compromised, I will speak with Staff and, if needed, step back from serving.
08	**Conflict Resolution**	Following Matthew 18:15-17, I will handle conflict with humility—going directly to the person, avoiding gossip, pursuing reconciliation, and involving the right leaders when needed.

WHAT WE COMMIT TO DO

01	**Serve Faithfully**	I will serve the full ministry year—August through July—and participate in weekly gatherings, leader trainings, and all required ministry rhythms.
02	**Consistent**	I will be on time, prepared, and engaged when serving. Consistency builds trust with students, families, leaders, and staff.
03	**Communicate**	If I need to miss a gathering, event, or serving commitment, I will tell my co-leaders and Staff as early as possible.
04	**Be a Teammate**	I will work with co-leaders, campus staff, parents, and SE Students leadership in a way that is clear, cooperative, and aligned.
05	**Safety Guidelines**	I will follow all Southeast and Southeast Students safety policies and boundaries at all times, including:

- Never being alone with a student in a private or isolated setting.
- Appropriate physical, emotional, spiritual, relational, and digital boundaries.
- Communicating with students only in transparent and approved ways.
- Reporting concerns, disclosures, or unsafe situations to Staff immediately.

AGREEMENT

By signing, I confirm I have read, understand, and agree to these commitments as a leader with Southeast Students. Failure to follow these commitments may result in being paused or removed from serving. If I have questions or cannot agree to any commitment, I will speak with Staff before serving.

PRINT NAME _____ LEADER SIGNATURE _____ DATE _____

SERIES ONE

ONE AT A TIME

THE WAY LOVE CHANGES THE WORLD · 6 WEEKS

SERIES DATES _____

SERIES OVERVIEW

ONE AT A TIME

We all want to be used to change the world. We don't want to spend our lives being time-wasters, or space-takers, or binge-watchers, or game-players. We want to be difference-makers. But it's easy to get caught up in the everyday stuff of life until the years slowly go by, and with each passing year the question gets louder: "Am I making any difference in this world?" Without a doubt, Jesus is the person who has made the biggest difference in all of history. So how did He do it? If we study His life in the Gospels, one particular phrase captures how Jesus had such an impact, and it's how He wants to use us: one at a time. Making a difference isn't measured by a viral post or a name on a building. It isn't a following or a fan base or a bank account. Want to make a difference? Focus on the one. That's the secret of the way of Jesus. One at a time.

SERIES OUTLINE

WEEK 1	**The Vision of Our Church**	Mark 5:21-43
WEEK 2	**One Party at a Time**	Luke 14:12-24
WEEK 3	**One Prayer at a Time**	Luke 18:1-8
WEEK 4	**One Conversation at a Time**	John 4:1-45
WEEK 5	**One Meal at a Time**	Luke 19:1-10
WEEK 6	**One Need at a Time**	Matthew 4:23-25

02

Follow up during the week. Students need someone to walk with them, not talk at them—a relationship carried past group can change a life. #leadertip

01 ONE AT A TIME
THE VISION OF OUR CHURCH

KEY TAKEAWAY

Jesus loved people one at a time—so should we.

CALL TO ACTION

Find one person you know who is far from Jesus and commit to loving them.

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1. Have you ever been so focused on a task that nothing could stop you from doing it?
2. What is something you would drop anything, no matter how important, to do?

BIBLICAL

1. Read Mark 5:21-43.
   - What words, ideas, or phrases stick out to you from these verses?
   - What questions do you have about these verses?
2. Reread Mark 5:21-24. Jesus is surrounded by people, but He chooses to help Jairus. Why just one person?
3. Reread Mark 5:24-34. Jesus let Himself be interrupted by stopping here. Why do you think this is?

APPLICABLE

1. Can you think of one person to commit to loving so they can better know Jesus? Who is it?
2. How can you go out of your way to love people one at a time?

PRAYER PROMPT

"God, thank you for loving me. Give me the eyes to see one person that doesn't know you and help me to love them."

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

Pray every day for the next week for God to show you one person to focus on loving.

02 ONE AT A TIME
ONE PARTY AT A TIME

KEY TAKEAWAY

Jesus invites everyone to the party—it's up to us to extend the invitation.

CALL TO ACTION

Make room in community to invite people far from God in and let them be loved.

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1. What is your favorite birthday party you had growing up?
2. How would you have felt if nobody you had invited had shown up?

BIBLICAL

1. Read Luke 14:12-24.
   - What words, ideas, or phrases stick out to you from these verses?
   - What questions do you have about these verses?
2. Reread Luke 14:16-20. Why were people rejecting the invitation to the feast?
3. Reread Luke 14:21-24. Who does Jesus say should be invited instead?

APPLICABLE

1. What are some excuses you might be using to avoid God's invitation?
2. Who is someone you could make the effort to reach out to and invite to the party?

PRAYER PROMPT

"God, thank you for inviting me to your great party. Help me see the people who don't know they are invited and extend the invite to them."

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

Plan a hang-out as a group and invite someone who doesn't yet know Jesus.

03 ONE AT A TIME
ONE PRAYER AT A TIME

KEY TAKEAWAY

We can love people one at a time by persistently praying for them.

CALL TO ACTION

Pray consistently that people far from God come to know Jesus.

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1. How do you feel when you think of prayer?
2. Why do you think God sometimes waits longer to answer prayers?

BIBLICAL

1. Read Luke 18:1-8.
   - What words, ideas, or phrases stick out to you from these verses?
   - What questions do you have about these verses?
2. Reread Luke 18:1. What does this say this parable means?
3. Reread Luke 18:6-8. How does this say that God will answer prayers?

APPLICABLE

1. Who is one person you can commit to praying for?
2. How can you build better habits of prayer to bring your requests to God more often?

PRAYER PROMPT

"God, thank you for hearing my prayers. Listen as I call out to you, and reveal yourself to my One."

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

Set a reminder to pray for your One every day.

04 ONE AT A TIME
ONE CONVERSATION AT A TIME

KEY TAKEAWAY

We can love people one at a time by having out-of-the-ordinary conversations.

CALL TO ACTION

Be willing to talk with those you normally avoid, and make room to tell them about Jesus.

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1. Why is it difficult to talk to people outside of our circle?
2. What kind of people do we typically avoid talking to?

BIBLICAL

1. Read John 4:1-45.
   - What words, ideas, or phrases stick out to you from these verses?
   - What questions do you have about these verses?
2. Reread John 4:7-9. Why would Jesus go out of His way to talk to someone He was supposed to avoid?
3. Reread John 4:25-26. This is the first time Jesus told anyone He was the Messiah. Why might He have told a Samaritan woman of all people?

APPLICABLE

1. Who is one person you can reach out to and share the good news of Jesus?
2. How can you break down barriers that might prevent people from hearing about Jesus?

PRAYER PROMPT

"God, thank you for being willing to reach me with your love. Help me to reach those who don't know you, even if it means getting uncomfortable. Amen."

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

Have one conversation that might be outside your comfort zone with someone who does not know Jesus.

05 ONE AT A TIME
ONE MEAL AT A TIME

KEY TAKEAWAY

Sharing a meal opens the door for God to change someone's life.

CALL TO ACTION

Open up your table and time to meet with someone and share the love of Jesus.

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1. If you could share a meal with any person throughout history, who would it be?
2. Why do you think some of the best conversations happen when sharing a meal?

BIBLICAL

1. Read Luke 19:1-10.
   - What words, ideas, or phrases stick out to you from these verses?
   - What questions do you have about these verses?
2. Reread Luke 19:5-6. How did Zacchaeus react to Jesus inviting Himself over? How did the crowd react? Why do you think this is?
3. Read Acts 2:42-47. The early church shared many meals together. What effect did this have on people who witnessed them?

APPLICABLE

1. Who are some people you wouldn't normally share a meal with? How can you go out of your way to open a table to them?
2. It's easy to make excuses for not sharing a meal with someone. What excuses can you surrender to God so you can love people better?

PRAYER PROMPT

"God, thank you for intentionally meeting me wherever I am. Give me eyes to see who I can invite to my table, your table."

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

One day this week, look for someone sitting alone at lunch. Sit with them, or invite them to your table.

06 ONE AT A TIME
ONE NEED AT A TIME

KEY TAKEAWAY

We can love people one at a time by meeting their needs.

CALL TO ACTION

Find ways to meet needs.

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1. If you could solve one problem in the world with a snap of your fingers, what would it be?
2. What are some things you might be cautious or scared of asking for help with?

BIBLICAL

1. Read Matthew 4:23-25.
   - What words, ideas, or phrases stick out to you from these verses?
   - What questions do you have about these verses?
2. Reread Matthew 4:23-25. What sorts of needs does Jesus meet? What does this tell you about the kingdom of heaven?
3. Read Matthew 15:29-31. This wasn't the only time Jesus did this. What does it tell you about Jesus' ministry?

APPLICABLE

1. What normally keeps you from helping meet the needs of others?
2. What are some ways you have been gifted to help meet the needs of others?

PRAYER PROMPT

"God, thank you for meeting my greatest need of all in Jesus. Strengthen me to meet the needs of others wherever I see them."

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

Look for one need around home and figure out a way to help out.

SERIES TWO

CHURCHY WORDS: THE UNHOLY TRINITY

THE WAR YOU DIDN'T KNOW YOU WERE FIGHTING · 4 WEEKS

SERIES DATES

SERIES OVERVIEW

CHURCHY WORDS: THE UNHOLY TRINITY

Churchy Words is the series we bring back every so often to dive deeper with our students on important subjects in the Bible. The word "trinity" doesn't appear in the Bible, but it helps us capture the mystery of who God is as three persons. Similarly, the "Unholy Trinity" isn't in Scripture, but it names the counterfeit triad the New Testament describes as forces opposing the church. In this series we walk through the book of James to expose the three enemies that constantly war against the life God is forming in us: the flesh, the world, and the devil. James shows us that spiritual warfare isn't just "out there" in obvious darkness—it shows up in our desires, our words, our pride, and the way we drift toward the values around us. The world pressures us from outside, the flesh pulls from inside, and the devil works to deceive, accuse, and divide. But James doesn't just diagnose the battle; he calls us to a faith that is active, surrendered, humble, and whole. Our prayer is that students would recognize the fight they're in, resist the lies they believe, and submit every part of their lives to Jesus—knowing victory isn't found in trying harder, but in drawing near to God, who gives more grace.

SERIES OUTLINE

WEEK 1	**The Flesh**	James 1:13-15; Galatians 5:16-17
WEEK 2	**The World**	James 4:1-10; 1 John 2:15-17
WEEK 3	**The Devil**	James 4:7-8; Ephesians 6:10-18
WEEK 4	**Heaven & Hell**	James 1:12-15; John 5:25-29; Matthew 13:47-50

03

Don't read off the curriculum. Know the passage ahead of time and ask in your own words; the less you look down, the more it feels like a real conversation. #leadertip

01 CHURCHY WORDS
THE FLESH

PASSAGE **James 1:13-15; Galatians 5:16-17**

KEY TAKEAWAY

Our biggest enemy is often our own desires—but the Spirit gives us power to win the fight.

CALL TO ACTION

Name one sinful desire you keep giving in to, and this week practice walking away from it in step with the Spirit.

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1. Have you ever done something that felt good in the moment but ended up not being good for you? Give an example.
2. Does it ever feel like you are fighting yourself for what you want to do?

BIBLICAL

1. Read James 1:13-15.
   - What words, ideas, or phrases stick out to you from these verses?
   - What questions do you have about these verses?
2. If our desires can give birth to sin, how do we prevent ungodly desires from growing?
3. Read Galatians 5:16-17. How does this say we can keep from doing what we don't want to do?

APPLICABLE

1. Where are you holding on to ungodly desires?
2. What are some ways to walk in step with the Spirit?

PRAYER PROMPT

"God, thank you for saving me from myself. Help me to always walk in step with you."

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

Pray every day for the Holy Spirit's help to walk away from sinful desires.

02 CHURCHY WORDS
THE WORLD

PASSAGE **James 4:1-10; 1 John 2:15-17**

KEY TAKEAWAY

You can't be best friends with the world and with God—choose God.

CALL TO ACTION

Identify one way you've been chasing the world's approval and trade it for a habit that draws you closer to God.

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1. What's an unpopular opinion you have that your friends would disagree with?
2. Have you ever known the right thing to do but felt pressure to do the opposite? Explain.

BIBLICAL

1. Read James 4:1-10.
   - What words, ideas, or phrases stick out to you from these verses?
   - What questions do you have about these verses?
2. Reread James 4:4. What does this say about how we relate to God?
3. Reread James 4:10. Instead of being friends of the world, how do we become friends with God?

APPLICABLE

1. Can you name any areas where you are a friend of the world?
2. What is a way you can grow in friendship with God?

PRAYER PROMPT

"God, thank you for not leaving me alone in this broken world. Help me to live as your friend in everything I do."

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

Examine your habits and identify one way you might be living for the world.

03 CHURCHY WORDS
THE DEVIL

PASSAGE **James 4:7-8; Ephesians 6:10-18**

KEY TAKEAWAY

The devil is real, but when we submit to God and resist him, he flees.

CALL TO ACTION

Pick the piece of God's armor you're weakest in, and ask God to strengthen you there this week.

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1. When you think of the devil, what comes to mind?
2. Where do you struggle resisting temptation?

BIBLICAL

1. Read James 4:7-8.
   - What words, ideas, or phrases stick out to you from these verses?
   - What questions do you have about these verses?
2. How does this say we should react when the devil tempts us?
3. Read Ephesians 6:13-18. What tools do we have from God to defend ourselves against attacks from the devil?

APPLICABLE

1. What is an area of your life you need to submit to God?
2. Which part of the "armor of God" do you need to grow in?

PRAYER PROMPT

"God, thank you for giving me what I need to resist the devil. Give me strength to keep resisting temptation, and to live for you always."

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

Read James 4:7 and pray for the strength to submit to God and resist the devil.

04 CHURCHY WORDS
HEAVEN & HELL

PASSAGE **James 1:12-15; John 5:25-29; Matthew 13:47-50**

KEY TAKEAWAY

Eternity is real, and God is inviting you—and the people around you—into life with Him forever.

CALL TO ACTION

Respond to God's invitation for yourself, then start one conversation with someone who needs to hear it.

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1. When you think of forever, what do you think of?
2. How does talking about heaven and hell make you feel?

BIBLICAL

1. Read James 1:12-15.
   - What words, ideas, or phrases stick out to you from these verses?
   - What questions do you have about these verses?
2. Reread James 1:12. What does God promise to those who love Him?
3. Jesus tells a story about judgement in Matthew 13:47-50. What kind of picture does this paint?

APPLICABLE

1. Do you need to respond to the invitation to the kingdom of heaven?
2. Do you know anyone who needs to hear this news? How can you start that conversation?

PRAYER PROMPT

"God, thank you for making a way for me to be with you. Help me live a life that points others toward you so they can also experience eternal life."

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

Prioritize a time this week to talk honestly with God about where you are with Him, and what one step closer would look like.

SERIES THREE

BEYOND BORING

THE INVITATION TO A BOLD FAITH · 4 WEEKS

SERIES DATES

SERIES OVERVIEW

BEYOND BORING

Throughout the book of Joshua, we see a theme of strength, courage, and radically bold faith. Joshua believed the promises God had spoken to his ancestors and his mentor—and reaffirmed to Joshua himself. His belief wasn't just an idea in his head; he moved beyond merely believing and lived a life of obedience even when it made him look weird.

Bold Faith isn't only for Bible characters or "professional Christians." It's for every person willing to take a step towards Jesus—and we experience it as we come to know the trustworthy, faithful nature of God. We want students to nurture a bold faith that lasts beyond their current stage of life: students who follow Jesus NOW and in the NEXT season.

One important connection for your students: bold faith doesn't have more power to save than childlike faith, but it helps us live a life of kingdom impact. Our goal is not to make students like Joshua but to connect them to Jesus, the author and perfecter of their faith.

SERIES OUTLINE

WEEK 1	**All In**	Joshua 1:1-18
WEEK 2	**Remember**	Joshua 3:1-17
WEEK 3	**Stand Out**	Joshua 6:1-20
WEEK 4	**Make It Yours**	Joshua 24:11-24

04

Get visual. A big sticky pad and a few markers pull everyone in—drawing or writing answers out makes the points stick. #leadertip

01 BEYOND BORING
ALL IN

PASSAGE **Joshua 1:1-18**

KEY TAKEAWAY

A faith that trusts God completely is anything but boring.

CALL TO ACTION

Name one obstacle keeping your faith "boring" and take one concrete step to trust God with it this week.

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1. How do you react when you feel bored?
2. How would you describe your relationship with God: boring or beyond boring? Why?

BIBLICAL

1. Read Joshua 1:1-18.
   - What words, ideas, or phrases stick out to you from these verses?
   - What questions do you have about these verses?
2. What are some of the promises God makes Israel?
3. Reread Joshua 1:16. How did Israel react when they heard the promises of God?

APPLICABLE

1. What are some obstacles keeping you from living a faith that is beyond boring?
2. What are some ways God may be calling you to put your faith in Him and trust Him more completely?

PRAYER PROMPT

"God, thank you for calling me to deeper faith. Be with me as I step out in faith and learn to trust you more."

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

Schedule a time this week to evaluate your relationship with God. Ask God where you need to trust Him more.

02 BEYOND BORING

REMEMBER

PASSAGE **Joshua 3:1-17**

KEY TAKEAWAY

Remembering what God has already done gives us faith to step into what He'll do next.

CALL TO ACTION

Write down three times God showed up for you, and let them push you into one new step of faith.

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1. When you are bored, what is your favorite thing to do to break the boredom?
2. If you were trapped in a room without those options, how would you pass the time?

BIBLICAL

1. Read Joshua 3:1-17.
   - What words, ideas, or phrases stick out to you from these verses?
   - What questions do you have about these verses?
2. How do you think the Israelites reacted when they crossed the river on dry ground?
3. How do you think it impacted how they thought about what God could do?

APPLICABLE

1. What does it look like for you to have a faith that is beyond boring?
2. What is a way you can actively step into that this week?

PRAYER PROMPT

"God, thank you for the amazing ways you have worked in my life. As I remember what you have done, inspire me to greater faith."

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

Set a timer for 3 minutes and write out times you can remember God showing up for you. Then write ways you can respond to His actions.

03 BEYOND BORING
STAND OUT

PASSAGE **Joshua 6:1-20**

KEY TAKEAWAY

Following God will sometimes make you stand out—and that's exactly the point.

CALL TO ACTION

Do one thing this week that shows your faith even if it feels weird—like inviting someone new to church.

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1. What is something you do that other people think is weird?
2. Does that ever impact how you act?

BIBLICAL

1. Read Joshua 6:1-20.
   - What words, ideas, or phrases stick out to you from these verses?
   - What questions do you have about these verses?
2. Reread Joshua 6:2-5. What does God command Joshua?
3. Why would God command something that might not make sense?

APPLICABLE

1. What is one way your faith in Jesus might cause you to stand out among your peers?
2. How does it help knowing that you aren't alone?

PRAYER PROMPT

"God, thank you for putting people around me to strengthen my faith. As I grow in community, help me grow in confidence and boldness."

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

Even though it might feel weird, invite one new person to church.

04 BEYOND BORING
MAKE IT YOURS

PASSAGE **Joshua 24:11-24**

KEY TAKEAWAY

Don't settle for a borrowed faith—choose today to make it your own.

CALL TO ACTION

Decide one area where you'll personally follow Jesus, and name the legacy of faith you want to leave.

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1. Are there any values, traditions, or principles your parents or grandparents have passed on to you?
2. How has this influenced how you have lived your life?

BIBLICAL

1. Read Joshua 24:11-24.
   - What words, ideas, or phrases stick out to you from these verses?
   - What questions do you have about these verses?
2. Joshua reminds Israel what the Lord had done up to this point. How can remembering help when we look forward?
3. Reread Joshua 24:19. Joshua says "You are not able to serve the Lord." What do you think he means?

APPLICABLE

1. How does your faith play into the kind of influence you want to have?
2. What steps do you need to take to work toward that?

PRAYER PROMPT

"God, thank you for showing me your faithfulness. As I own my faith, help me not settle for a boring faith, but walk in one that is active and fulfilling."

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

Read Hebrews 11:1-12:2. Examine the stories of lasting faith, and ask God to show you how you can grow toward that kind of faith.

SERIES FOUR

THOSE PEOPLE

LOVING THE ONES WE'D RATHER AVOID · 3 WEEKS

SERIES DATES _____



SERIES OVERVIEW

THOSE PEOPLE

Jesus was hated by many because of who was at his table—quite literally who he shared meals with. He was mocked for eating with "sinners and tax collectors" because he wasn't just content with it—he was passionate about reaching "those people." In Acts we see the Church beginning to be led by the Spirit of Christ to do this same thing. It wasn't natural for them but eventually the apostles began to see the joy of inviting people far from God to join them at the table. Today, the church is still on mission to bring people to the table—even people who hate God, hate us, and who sometimes we hate.

SERIES OUTLINE

WEEK 1	**People Who Hate God**	Acts 8:4-13
WEEK 2	**People Who Hate Me**	Acts 9:1-19
WEEK 3	**People I Hate**	Acts 10:34-48

05

Involve every student. Ask a question for everyone to answer. Don't rush to fill the silence or answer the question. Ask questions of their questions. #leadertip

01 THOSE PEOPLE

PEOPLE WHO HATE GOD

PASSAGE **Acts 8:4-13**

KEY TAKEAWAY

God loved us while we were still far from Him—so we can love people who are far from Him too.

CALL TO ACTION

Think of someone who doesn't love God and find one specific way to show them His love this week.

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1. What are some of your biggest pet-peeves that drive you crazy?
2. What are some things that you do that drive other people crazy?

BIBLICAL

1. Read Acts 8:4-13.
   - What words, ideas, or phrases stick out to you from these verses?
   - What questions do you have about these verses?
2. What do you think Simon the Sorcerer cared about most—God or the world?
3. Read 1 John 2:15. What does the Bible say about people who love the world?

APPLICABLE

1. How does God feel about people who hate Him? (Hint: read Romans 5:8.)
2. How does that change the way you view, treat, speak to, encourage, and reach people far from God?

> **PRAYER PROMPT**
>
> *"God, thank you for loving me even when I don't deserve it. Help me to be a loving presence and to show others—even those who hate you—your love."*

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

Think of someone you know who does not love God. Find one way to show them the love of God this week.

02 THOSE PEOPLE

PEOPLE WHO HATE ME

PASSAGE **Acts 9:1-19**

KEY TAKEAWAY

The people who reject you today could be God's chosen instruments tomorrow.

CALL TO ACTION

Pray each day this week for someone who's been unkind to you. Look for a way to love them.

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1. Have you ever started to like a specific food you used to hate? What was it?
2. What did it take for you to try it again?

BIBLICAL

1. Read Acts 9:1-19.
   - What words, ideas, or phrases stick out to you from these verses?
   - What questions do you have about these verses?
2. Reread Acts 9:15. What do you think God meant by "chosen instrument"?
3. How would our view of people change if we saw them as God's chosen instruments?

APPLICABLE

1. Is there anyone you need to start seeing as a "chosen instrument"?
2. How can you react in a loving way to people who don't accept you?

> **PRAYER PROMPT**
>
> *"God, thank you for loving me. Help me to live in a way that honors you and to lovingly reach out to those who may hate me."*

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

Set a reminder each day this week to pray for the opportunity to love those who may hate you.

03 THOSE PEOPLE
PEOPLE I HATE

PASSAGE **Acts 10:34-48**

KEY TAKEAWAY

God shows no favoritism—so we don't get to pick and choose who we love.

CALL TO ACTION

List the people you struggle to get along with, and next to each name write one way you'll love them.

LEADER NOTES

QUESTIONS

PERSONAL

1. Have you ever had a family member, friend, or classmate you have a hard time getting along with?
2. How does this impact how you treat them?

BIBLICAL

1. Read Acts 10:34-48.
   - What words, ideas, or phrases stick out to you from these verses?
   - What questions do you have about these verses?
2. Reread Acts 10:34. What does it mean that "God shows no favoritism"?
3. How does knowing that change the way we interact with people, especially those we dislike?

APPLICABLE

1. Why do you think Jesus calls us to love people we don't like?
2. How can we begin to love people who are hard for us to love?

> **PRAYER PROMPT**
>
> *"God, thank you for showing me your love even though I don't deserve it. Help me to love everyone, even when I don't feel like it."*

PERSONAL CHALLENGE

Write out a list of people you don't get along with. Beside each name, write one way you can love them.

FOR YOUR GROUP

NOTES

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NOTES

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SPACE TO DRAW

SKETCH

SKETCH



WHO'S YOUR ONE ?

LEAVING THE 99 FOR THE 1